

WATER CO-OPERATIVE

Board Meeting Minutes

May 18, 2026

Date: May 18, 2026

Type: Board Meeting

Organization: Water Co-operative

Status: DRAFT — Pending Approval

ATTENDANCE

Current Board Members:

- Keith
- Gina
- Kylee

Prospective New Members (pending vote):

- Julio (present)
- Brett Hutchinson (absent — interest submitted)
- Kathleen Richardson (absent — interest submitted)
- Dennis Dumais (absent — interest submitted)

Resigning Members:

- Dave (resignation noted; attendance for transition purposes)
- Shane (resignation noted; available to assist the co-op as needed)

Also Present:

- Caroline — Community Committee Representative
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1. CALL TO ORDER

The meeting was called to order by the board. Quorum was confirmed with current board members present. The purpose of the meeting was noted as addressing member transitions, governance structure, communications, financial management, and infrastructure matters.

2. RESIGNATIONS

The board formally acknowledged the resignations of Sarah, Dave, and Shane. Their contributions to the co-op were recognized.

- Dave confirmed his resignation and indicated he is in the process of finalizing the financial books.

- Shane confirmed his resignation from the board but expressed willingness to assist the co-op when needed.
- The vacancies created by these resignations were noted.

3. NEW MEMBER APPLICATIONS & BOARD APPOINTMENTS

The following individuals expressed interest in joining the board. A formal vote will be conducted to confirm membership and assign roles.

Candidates:

- Julio (present)
- Brett Hutchinson (absent — interest submitted)
- Dennis Dumais (absent — interest submitted)
- Kathleen Richardson (absent — interest submitted; not voted upon at this meeting)

Item	Motion	Result
Admission of Dennis Dumais as board member	Moved & Seconded	Accepted
Admission of Brett Hutchinson as board member	Moved & Seconded	Accepted
Julio — Communications Officer (official AFRWC title)	Moved & Seconded	Accepted
Keith — President	Confirmed	Acclaimed
Gina — Vice President	Confirmed	Acclaimed
Kylee — Secretary	Confirmed	Acclaimed
Treasurer	TBD	TBD

Note: The co-op requires a minimum of four positions per AFRWC: President, Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer.

4. GOVERNANCE & BOARD STRUCTURE

- The minimum required board positions were reviewed: President, Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer.
- The Vice President position is currently vacant and must be filled.
- Clear role definitions and access to relevant information for each board member were discussed as a priority.
- Regular board meetings with formal voting procedures are essential to proper governance.
- A member will research the rules and requirements of the Alberta Rural Water Co-op Federation to ensure ongoing compliance.

5. COMMUNICATIONS & WEBSITE

- The group identified a need for a single, consistent communication channel to reduce confusion and limit mass emailing.
- Current channels include a WhatsApp group and the co-op website; both require improved access and information sharing.
- The website is currently hosted on a personal business domain and is not fully accessible to all board members.
- Plans were discussed to update the website with a FAQ section, an online inquiry form, and a members-only section for sensitive information.
- One designated person will be responsible for managing all outgoing communications and the website portal.

6. FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

- The co-op financial accounts and community committee accounts are currently combined, which requires correction.
- The board agreed to separate these accounts for transparency and proper financial management.
- Dave is currently working on finalizing the financial books. Timely and accurate financial reporting was emphasized.
- Mandatory member fees and voluntary donations must be tracked and reported separately.
- Financial slides and spreadsheets are to be reviewed and confirmed for accuracy.

7. WATER & IRRIGATION SYSTEM

- The co-op is responsible for the drinking water supply. Irrigation water is managed separately by the United Irrigation Deer District (UID).
- Members pay for irrigation services separately; non-payment results in water shutoff.
- Proper maintenance of the irrigation system is required to prevent issues such as frozen pipes.
- Appropriate water filters for the irrigation system are to be identified and ordered to ensure water quality and system longevity.
- Clear communication to all members regarding water responsibilities and co-op versus UID jurisdiction was identified as important.
- Irrigation water has been turned on for the season. Members are reminded to conserve water.

8. COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE

- Discussion was held regarding the placement of a shed for tools and equipment within the common green space owned by the co-op.
- The preferred location must be central and accessible, avoiding power lines and cistern areas.
- The community will be consulted to confirm the final location before proceeding.

9. ACTION ITEMS

Action Item	Responsible	Status
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Research Alberta Rural Water Co-op Federation rules and governance requirements	Board	Pending
Designate communications lead; update website with FAQ, inquiry form, and members-only section	Board	Pending
Separate co-op and community committee financial accounts	Board / Treasurer	Pending
Finalize and deliver financial books and reporting	Dave	In Progress
Identify and order appropriate water filters for irrigation system	Board	Pending
Confirm shed placement location with community input	Board	Pending
Conduct formal vote on new member admissions and role appointments	Board	TBD

10. ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting was adjourned. Date of next meeting to be confirmed by the board.

Minutes recorded by: _____ Date: _____

Approved by: _____ Date: _____

These minutes are considered DRAFT until formally approved at the next board meeting.